

C2 English Vocabulary List (CEFR)

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Featured cards

debacle · noun · /dɪˈbækl̩/

A complete and shameful failure

“The launch turned into a public debacle.”

esoteric · adjective · /ɪˈsɒtɪrɪk/

Known or understood by only a few

“His research covers esoteric parts of physics.”

egregious · adjective · /ɪˈɡrɪdʒiəs/

Very bad and easily noticed

“The report contained egregious errors.”

ephemeral · adjective · /ɪˈfɛmɪrəl/

Lasting for a very short time

“Fame can be ephemeral — enjoyed briefly and quickly forgotten.”

echelon · noun · /ɪˈtʃələn/

A level or rank within an organization

“He reached the top echelon of the firm.”

nadir · noun · /ˈneɪdər/

The lowest point of something

“That loss was the nadir of his career.”

zephyr · noun · /ˈzɛfər/

A soft, gentle breeze

“A cool zephyr moved through the trees.”

cognizant · adjective · /ˈkɒɡnɪzənt/

Aware of or knowing about something

“She is cognizant of the risks involved.”

panacea · noun · /ˈpænəsi/

A solution said to fix all problems

“Technology is not a panacea for schools.”

erudite · adjective · /ɪˈrʊdaɪt/

Showing great knowledge from long study

“The erudite professor spoke five languages.”

sanguine · adjective · /ˈsæŋwɪn/

Hopeful and positive about the future

“She remains sanguine about the election.”

maelstrom · noun · /ˈmeɪlstrɒm/

A situation of great confusion or trouble

“The country fell into a maelstrom of protest.”

All C2 words

antediluvian adjective

apocryphal adjective /əˈpɒkrɪfəl/

bombastic adjective /bɒmˈbæstɪk/

cacophony noun /kəˈkɒfəni/

chicanery noun /ˈʃɪkənəri/

cognizant adjective /ˈkɒɡnɪzənt/

copacetic adjective

debacle noun /dɪˈbækl̩/

defenestrate verb

denouement noun /ˈdeɪnuːmɛnt/

desultory adjective /dɪˈsʌltəri/

diaphanous adjective /daɪˈæfənəs/

echelon noun /ɪˈtʃələn/

effervescent adjective /ɪˈfɛrɪvəsənt/

egregious adjective /ɪˈɡrɪdʒiəs/

ephemeral adjective /ɪˈfɛmɪrəl/

equivocate verb /ɪˈkwɒvəkeɪt/

erudite adjective /ɪˈrʊdaɪt/

esoteric adjective /ɪˈsɒtɪrɪk/

fastidious adjective /fæˈstɪdiəs/

garrulous adjective /ˈɡærjʊləs/

grandiloquent adjective /ˈɡrændɪlɒkwənt/

hackneyed adjective /ˈhæknɪd/

iconoclast noun /ɪˈkɒnɒklæst/

ineffable adjective /ɪˈnɛfəbəl/

inscrutable adjective /ɪnˈskrʊtəbəl/

lachrymose adjective

limpid adjective

maelstrom noun /ˈmeɪlstrɒm/

mellifluous adjective

nadir noun /ˈneɪdər/

obfuscate verb /əˈbfʊskeɪt/

obsequious adjective /əˈbɪsɪkwɪəs/

panacea noun /ˈpænəsi/

pellucid adjective

perfunctory adjective /pəˈfʌŋktəri/

perspicacious adjective /pəˈspɪkəs/

propitious adjective /prəˈpɪʃəs/

pusillanimous adjective /pjuːˈlænɪmʊs/

quixotic adjective /kwɪˈksɪtɪk/

recalcitrant adjective /rɪˈkælsɪtrənt/

salubrious adjective

sanguine adjective /ˈsæŋwɪn/

solipsism noun

soporific adjective

surreptitious adjective /sɪˈrɪptɪʃəs/

sycophant noun

truculent adjective /ˈtrʊkjʊlənt/

vicissitude noun /vɪˈsɪsɪtʊd/

zephyr noun /ˈzɛfɪr/